

Floats with no width, and the blocks that contain floats

A float with no width

A left float holding "aa" is as wide as that word, and "bb" sits beside it on the same line.

aa**bb**

A right float holding "aa" is as wide as that word and sits at the right margin; "bb" is at the left margin on the same line.

aa

A left float holding a paragraph that wraps takes the whole width, and "bb" goes below it.

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bb

A float with no width beside a 30mm blue float is as wide as "aa bb", and "cc" sits beside both.

30mm wide aa bbcc

A float holding a 50mm blue block is 50mm wide.

a 50mm block

A right float holding a table is as wide as the table.

cell one cell two

The blocks that contain floats

A plain yellow parent does not contain its float: it is a line with no height, and "zz" sits beside the float.

30mm by 12mm ZZ

A parent with overflow: hidden contains its float: the yellow box is 12mm tall, and "zz" goes below.

30mm by 12mm

ZZ

A parent with display: flow-root contains its float: the yellow box is 12mm tall, and "zz" goes below.

30mm by 12mm

ZZ

A clear at the end of the parent makes it contain the float, as a clearfix does: the yellow box is 12mm tall, and "zz" goes below.

30mm by 12mm

ZZ

A yellow float 80mm wide contains its float: it is 12mm tall, and "zz" sits beside it.

30mm by 12mm ZZ